Platform Operations Runbook

Site Reliability Engineering · RB-OPS-04 · Version 3.1 · Updated 2 September 2026

> Fictional sample document for testing a domain-specialist RAG.

1. Service level objectives

Service tier	Availability SLO (30 days)	Latency SLO	Error budget
Tier 1 (checkout, payments, login)	99.95%	p95 under 300 ms	21.6 minutes per month
Tier 2 (search, catalogue, notifications)	99.9%	p95 under 500 ms	43.2 minutes per month
Tier 3 (reporting, internal tools)	99.5%	p95 under 2 s	3.6 hours per month

When a service has used more than 75% of its monthly error budget, feature releases stop and only reliability fixes are deployed until the budget recovers.

2. Incident severities

Severity	Definition	Acknowledge within	Status updates
SEV1	Tier 1 outage or data loss, or a security breach in progress	5 minutes	Every 30 minutes
SEV2	Major degradation with a workaround, or a Tier 2 outage	15 minutes	Every 60 minutes
SEV3	Minor issue, no customer impact	4 business hours	Daily

Every SEV1 and SEV2 needs a blameless postmortem published within 5 business days, with owners and due dates for each action item.

3. Deployments

Production deployments use a canary: 5% of traffic for 15 minutes, then 25% for 15 minutes, then 100%. The pipeline rolls back automatically if the canary error rate exceeds 2% or p95 latency rises by more than 20% against the baseline.

No production deployments on Fridays after 15:00 IST, on public holidays, or during the annual festival sale freeze (the two weeks before Diwali). Emergency fixes during a freeze need approval from the incident commander.

4. Backups and disaster recovery

Tier 1 databases have a recovery point objective (RPO) of 15 minutes and a recovery time objective (RTO) of 1 hour. Point-in-time recovery is kept for 14 days; daily snapshots for 35 days. Backups are copied to a second region. Restores are tested monthly and a full region failover drill runs every quarter.

5. On-call

On-call rotations are one week long and hand over on Mondays at 10:00 IST. Each rotation has a primary and a secondary. The primary must acknowledge pages within the times in section 2; unacknowledged pages escalate to the secondary after 10 minutes and to the engineering manager after 20 minutes. On-call engineers get a compensatory day off after any night with more than 2 hours of incident work.